

Assignment Brief: Transitioning to the Rights-Based Aged Care Act and Regulatory Framework

Course/Module: Balancing Duty of Care with Dignity of Risk

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

Aged Care vs. Hospital Environments

The new guide highlights a major difference between hospitals and aged care: aged care is not just a clinical space, but a home where people live. Research the physical design of residential care homes. How can a facility be designed to look and feel like a comfortable home while still meeting strict medical cleaning and infection control standards?

Question 2:

The Anatomy of Eye Protection

The presenter notes that eye protection is often forgotten, but it is critical because droplets that land on the eyes can drain directly into the nose and respiratory tract. Research the human "nasolacrimal system" (tear ducts). Explain in simple terms how pathogens on the surface of the eye are able to travel into the respiratory system.

Question 3:

Dignity of Risk vs. Isolation Harm

The standards emphasize "Dignity of Risk," meaning residents have the right to make their own choices even if there is some risk. Furthermore, the guide warns that prolonged isolation during outbreaks can cause severe emotional and physical harm. Research the psychological impacts of isolation on older adults. What is one alternative strategy care homes can use to keep residents socially connected during an outbreak?

Question 4:**Aerosol-Generating Procedures**

While surgical masks provide excellent protection in most daily scenarios, the guide recommends higher-level N95 respirators during procedures that generate high amounts of small airborne particles (aerosols), such as using a nebulizer. Research what makes a medical procedure "aerosol-generating." List three common examples of these procedures used in elderly care.

Question 5:**Understanding Antimicrobial Resistance**

The guide introduces "Antimicrobial Stewardship" (AMS) to ensure antibiotics are used correctly and to fight rising resistance. Research "Antimicrobial Resistance" (AMR). In your own words, explain what AMR is and why it is a particularly dangerous threat to vulnerable residents in shared living spaces

Question 6:**Outbreak Response Frameworks**

The webinar explains that daily infection prevention is managed by the new IPC Guide, but active respiratory outbreaks should be managed using the national "CDNA" guidelines. Research the acronym "CDNA" in the context of public health. What is the full name of this network, and what is its primary role in managing infectious diseases?

Question 7:**Overcoming Vaccine Hesitancy**

The Chief Nursing Officer points out that while double-vaccination is highly recommended for those over 75, only 53% of aged care residents were up to date at the time of the webinar. Research the concept of "vaccine hesitancy" in older populations. What are two common reasons why older adults or their families might decline or delay getting vaccinated?

Question 8:**Home Care Safety Hazard Mapping**

In home care settings, there is no single mandated environmental risk assessment tool, meaning individual providers must design their own to use before beginning care. Imagine you are a home care worker entering a client's private house for the first time. List five environmental hazards (e.g., related to hygiene, clutter, or pets) you would look for to ensure a safe visit.

Question 9:

Methods for Practical Skill Assessments

Because of high staff turnover and rapid knowledge drop-off, the webinar states that staff IPC competency must be evaluated continuously. Research alternative ways to assess practical skills like hand hygiene. What is the difference between a written multiple-choice test and an "observational audit" in a clinical setting?

Question 10:

The Hierarchy of Controls

The presentation refers to the "Hierarchy of Controls" and points out that Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) is actually the least effective way to control a risk, while vaccination is highly protective. Research the "Hierarchy of Controls" framework. Sketch or list the five tiers of this hierarchy from most effective to least effective, and explain why PPE is always placed at the very bottom.

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.